

Sourcing Materials

Thankfully I flew through inspection by my Neth'Tel contact, the legend of *Gorthaur oer a Dhaerlind* starts today. With that dull military matter out of the way I can return to astronomy, alchemy, and engineering.

Science is hard. I have been testing components for a week, but the requirements for this hypothetical astral device are proving mercurial. I look like a madman running around a notebook and with my tuning fork tapping it to an ever-expanding list of absurdities. No mundane metal is suitable; alchemical theory demands materials that “sympathize” with my target, but how am I supposed to know what the stars are made of!? I’ve resorted to improvisations: a grey stone disk chipped from the tower’s foundation (surprisingly resonant when tapped), a piece of oxidized scrap from my old field gear (the rust flakes off too easily—must stabilize), a handful of earthen clay tinted blue with crushed lapis, and a shard of mountain ice I acquired under circumstances no one needs to record (though I can't get Frankie to shut up about it). The pale white element has been the trickiest; dust refuses to hold a consistent form, and powdered bone feels melodramatic even for me.

I’ve sketched the rudimentary runic shorthand for each material beside their test results, more for my memory than anything else—*Gonn* for the stone, *Arus* for the rust, *Kemen* for the clay, *Helca* for the ice, and *Asto* for the dust. Merely markers for now, placeholders in a lattice I can only really see in my mind's eye. I still need a material to build the casing out of, and a power source. I'll have Chauncy scout out some of the artificers in Eitheloth's many workshops. I guess I have military standing to flaunt now.